The ultra-protestant proletarian idea of *secularism*‡ § ¶ that was well embedded in me ensured that the indigenous narratives of history appeared to *disdain* and oppose the academia.[6] But that was not the core problem. It had also assured this belief within me that the thump of every invader's horse added glory for India time and again.* † ‡ § ¶ Just to set the perspective in order, I must quote Karl Marx. He says as below:

> England, it is true, in causing a social revolution in Hindostan, was actuated only by the vilest interests, and was stupid in her manner of enforcing them. But that is not the question. The question is, can mankind fulfil its destiny without a fundamental revolution in the social state of Asia? If not, whatever may have been the crimes of England she was the unconscious tool of history in bringing about that revolution.**
>
> England has to fulfill a double mission in India: one destructive, the other regenerating – the annihilation of [the] old Asiatic society, and the laying the material foundations of Western society in Asia . . . When a great social revolution shall have mastered the results of the bourgeois epoch . . . and subjected them to the common control of the most advanced peoples, then only will human progress cease to resemble that hideous, pagan idol, who would not drink the nectar but from the skulls of the slain.††

So however proletarian* the vouch for the character of Marx may be, with respect to India he was very clear that British rule was mandatory to kill the *Asiatic backwardness*.†

> I often say that perhaps time only is God and vice versa. It is powerful and is potent to flip the things beyond general expectations.

It took me a good time of almost a decade to realize the vitriol injected in me by the ideas of Marxism. A trip to the unbelievably terrific architectural marvels, Kailasa Mandir and Ajanta Caves[7] came out as an antidote against the *flu*[8] I was infected with. And once this infection was gone, the key thing in the *neo-itinerary* was about unlearning the opinions fed in as history and learning history through the primary contemporary sources.[9]

Perhaps, had I learnt Marx's views on British colonization of India through the primary sources,[10] (refer earlier page where Marx is quoted) this would have been clear that he was certainly not a friend of India. It left me wondering that if such was the view of Marx, then how did the communists fighting against the British keep eulogizing him as a godly figure of ideas for long?

As I began to dabble in the primary sources to understand our past, I got exposed to not only how effective the *Bharatiya* resistance was to the invading forces right from the period of Umayyads but also to the atrocities and crimes committed by them that had long remained hidden under the carpet